short, confuse the temporal structures that belong to the world as “seen from the outside” with the aspects of the world that we observe and which depend on our being part of it, on our being situated within it.[95]

In order to use a geographical map, it is not enough to look at it from the outside: we must know where we are situated in relation to what it represents. In order to understand our experience of space, it is not enough to think of Newtonian space. We must remember that we see this space from inside it, that we are localized. In order to understand time, it is not enough to think of it from outside: it is necessary to understand that we, in every moment of our experience, are situated *within* time.



Universal man at the center of the cosmos, in *Liber Divinorum Operum* by Hildegard of Bingen (1164–70).

We observe the universe from within it, interacting with a minuscule portion of the innumerable variables of the cosmos. What we see is a blurred image. This blurring suggests that the dynamic of the universe with which we interact is governed by entropy, which measures the amount of blurring. It measures something that relates to us more than to the cosmos.

We are getting up dangerously close to ourselves. We can almost hear Tiresias, in *Oedipus*, saying: “Stop! Or you will find yourself” . . . Or Hildegard of Bingen, who in the twelfth century seeks the absolute and ends up by putting “universal man” at the center of the cosmos.

But before getting to this “us,” another chapter is required, to show how the growth in entropy—perhaps only an effect of perspective—might give rise to the entire, vast phenomenon of time.

Let me summarize the hard ground covered in the last two chapters, in the hope that I have not already lost all my readers. At the fundamental level, the world is a collection of events *not* ordered in time. These events manifest relations between physical variables that are, a priori, on the same level. Each part of the world interacts with a small part of all the variables, the value of